A short introduction to JIRA for the End of Study Project

Olivier Paul, 13/08/2026

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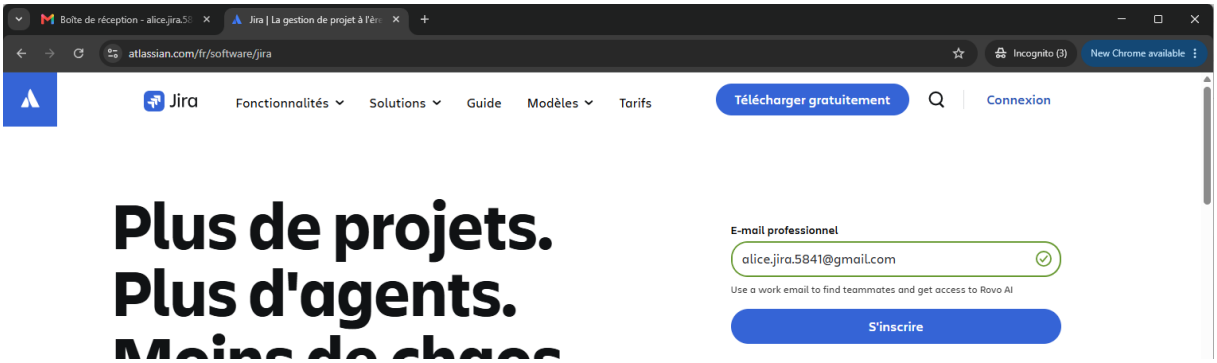
Introduction

According to Atlassian the company making JIRA, “Jira is a workflow management system that lets you track your work in any scenario”.

This tutorial will walk you through the initial setup necessary to manage a project. Apart from the account creation and initial wizard execution which should be performed by each member of the team, other activities (starting at “team management”) need to be performed only once for the whole team.

Creating an account

Connect to https://www.atlassian.com/software/jira and **enter your email address in the registration field**.



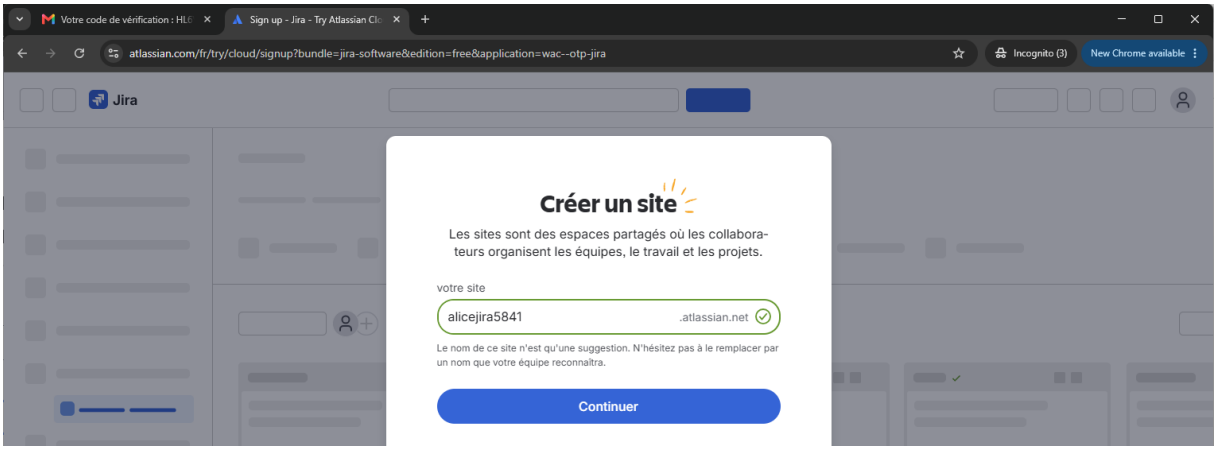
After confirming the address with the validation code, enter your name and a password.

In the scenario followed in this tutorial, students Alice and Bob set up their Jira account and will later be a part of a project team. Another user called John is used as their tutor. The project consists in creating a lab using Checkpoint R82 Next Generation FW.

During the tutorial, you must replace references to users Alice, Bob and John with you own names and email accounts.

Initial wizard

Initial site setup



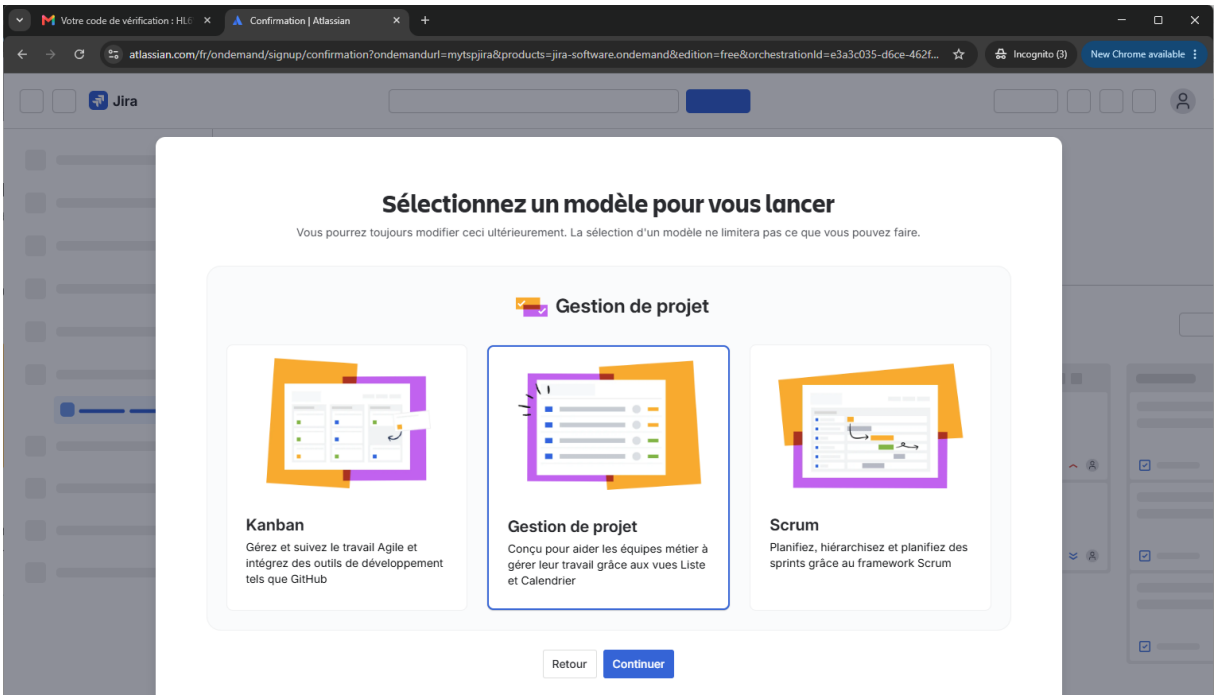
Once the address is validated, a wizard is used to guide the user for the creation of its site and first project space.

Select the name of the site that will be used as the home for your projects. The name must be unique among all existing Jira sites. Note that this name cannot be changed later. One site can be used to manage multiple projects, therefore, if you plan to use JIRA for multiple projects, do not make the name project-specific. In the tutorial we chose **mytspjira** for Alice's site and **mypfejira** was used for Bob's site. Note that for most Atlassian plans, only one site can be created per organization/user.

Initial project setup

Once the site is set up, you can select the type of project management template you want to use to manage your activities.

As you can see JIRA can be used to manage multiple types of activities. All the templates share the same core notions and functionalities but can include domain specific vocabulary, data types and functions. For instance, objects used for software development will include fields and functions associated to software repositories whereas objects used for finance will include fields and functions associated with budgeting activities.

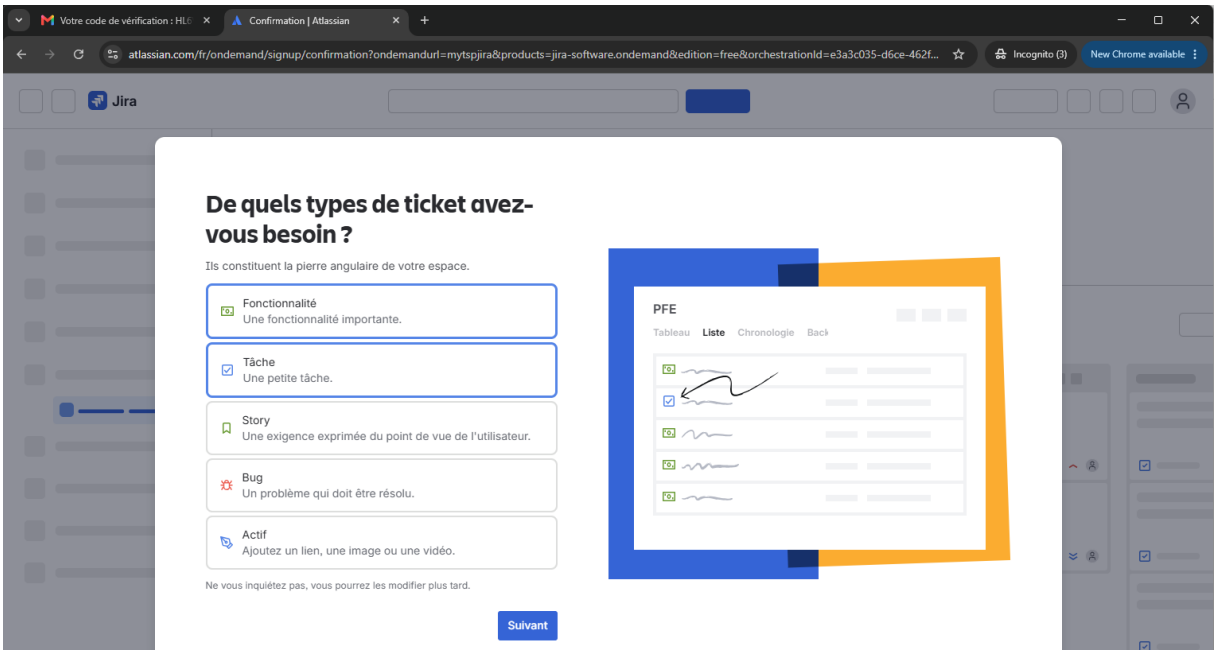


Select "Project Management" and "Project Management" again. You can later use other types of templates if you feel like it.

In Jira the environment used to manage a project is called a "Space". The next window gives you the ability to choose the project name. This name can be changed later. **Select "PFE" as the name of the project**.

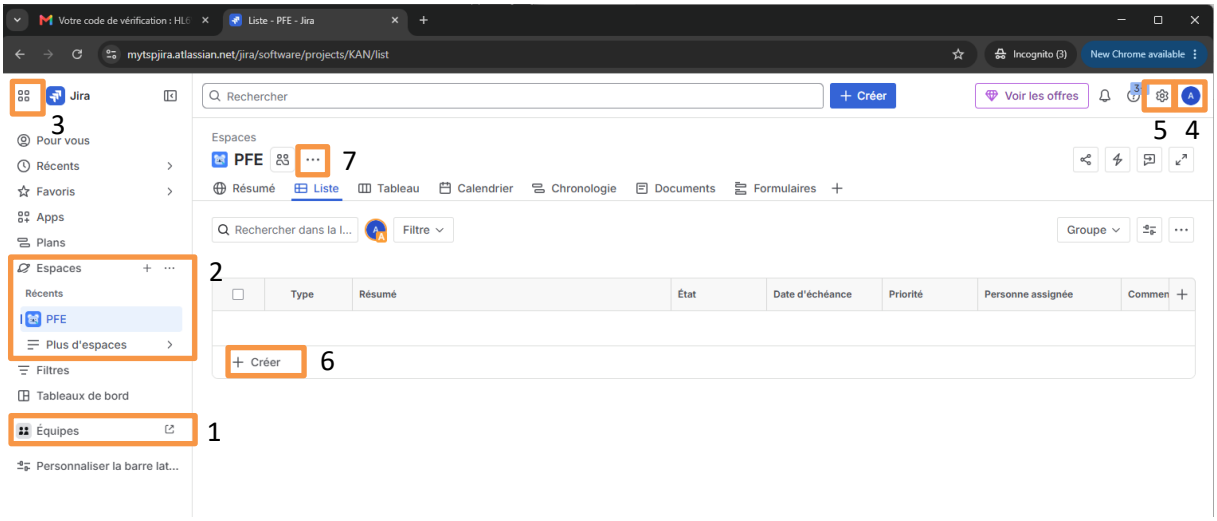
Activities in Jira can be decomposed in different ways. Let us start with the default type of work items (Task' and 'Feature'). We will later add another type of work item. **Click "Next".**

The progress of a task can be tracked using a progress indicator. By default, the indicator values range from "Idea" to "Done". **Accept this default range**.



The wizard ends here and you get access to the Jira Dashboard.

The Jira Dashboard

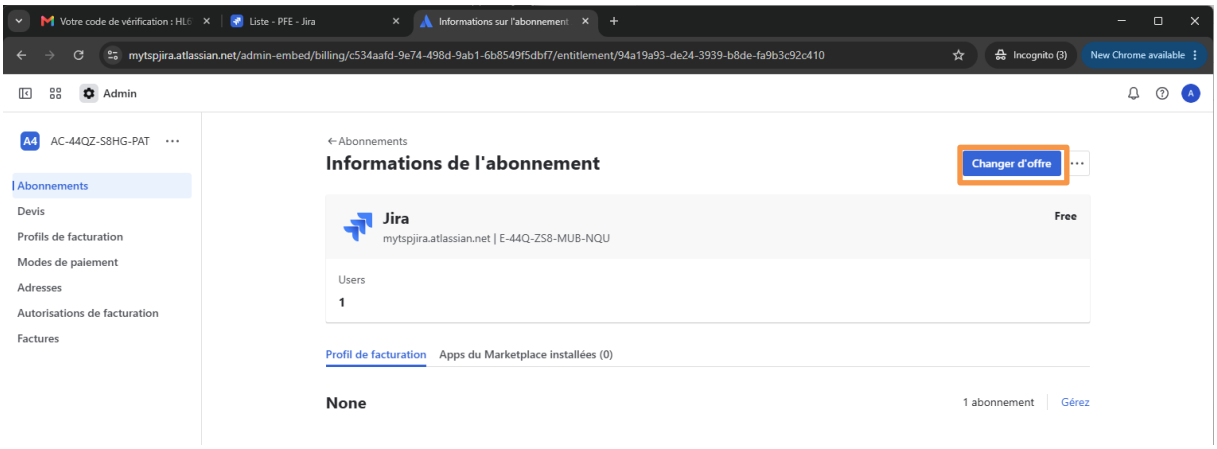


Let's have a look at the Jira dashboard. We are presented with the current status of the "PFE" space. No task has been created so far. Should you have to find that space again or access other spaces, this can be done through the "Spaces (2)" menu. The "Jira (3)" menu allows you to access other Atlassian applications. Button (4) allows you to manage your account while button (5) allows you to manage site-level settings. Button (7) allows you to manage project-level settings. Finally (6) allows you to create new tasks.

Administrative operations

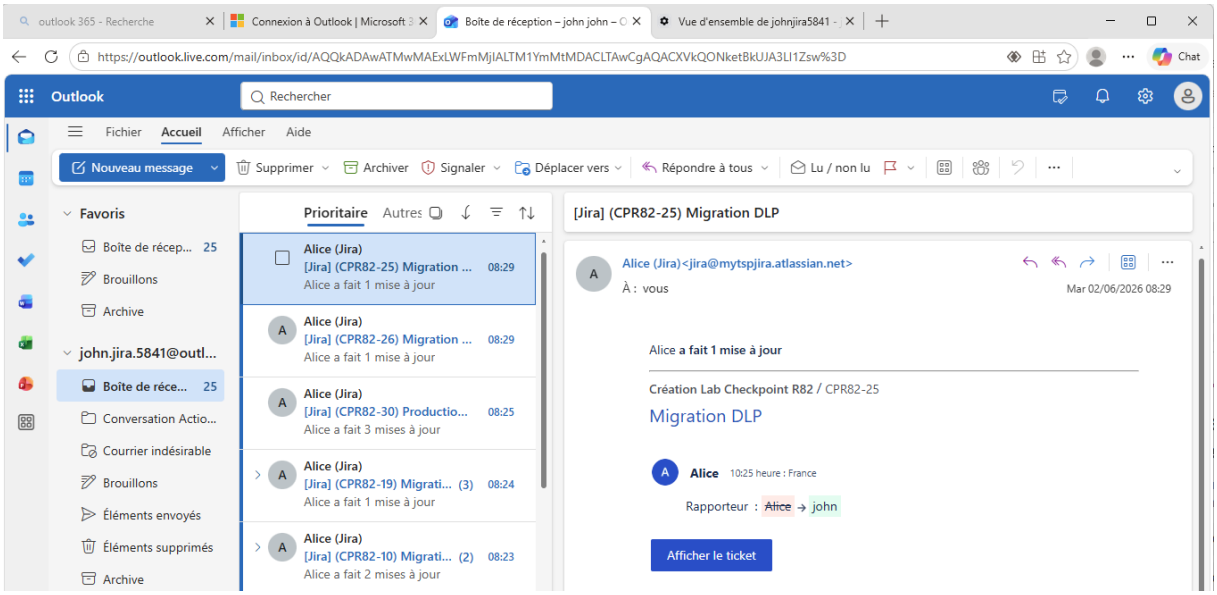
Moving to the free plan

Before doing anything, let us move from the premium plan to the free plan. To do this **click on (5)** and **select "Billing"**. In the new window, **select "Change Plan"**. Finally **click on "Downgrade to Free"**, **confirm the downgrade and skip the survey**.



Managing notifications and emails

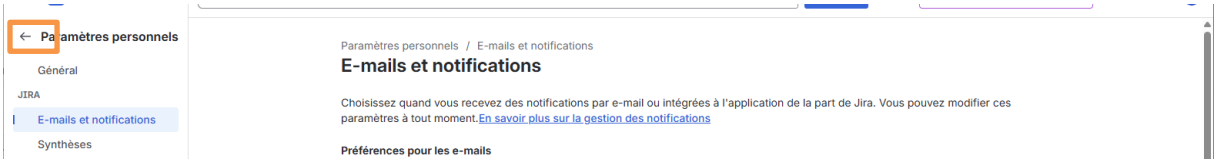
By default, any action in an Atlassian app will generate notifications and emails. This can result in thousands of messages being sent every day. The free plan is, however, limited to 100 emails per day. Even 100 emails can be a lot though, especially if you follow multiple projects. Managing notifications is also important in the free plan to avoid losing important emails that would have been emitted over the limit.



To reduce or disable email notifications, **go to the Jira Dashboard window**, **click on the configuration wheel (5) and select "Notification settings"**. There you can tune the notifications to either disable email notifications, choose which notification you want to receive or choose if you want to receive digests instead.

As a first step, it might be a good idea to disable email notifications and only keep digests.

Note that these settings are personal and do not affect notifications received by other participants in the project. Notifications can also be managed at the project level in the "space settings".



Click on the "back" arrow to go back to the Jira Dashboard.

Managing marketing emails

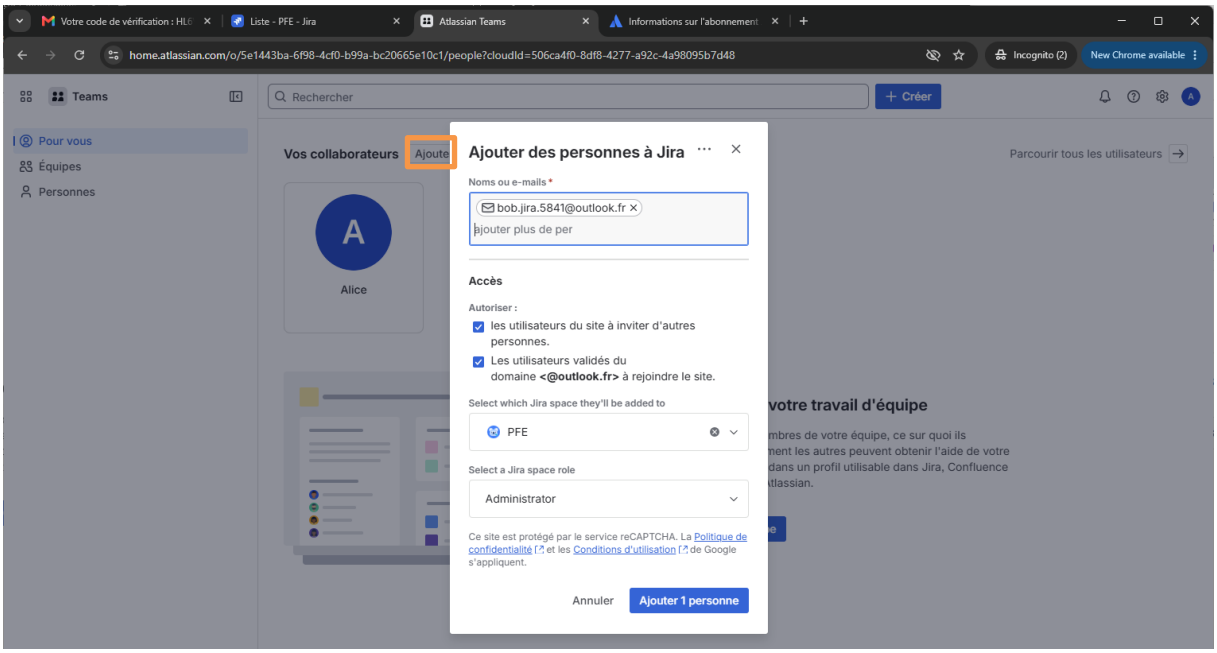
Atlassian send quite a large amount of marketing emails to Jira users. To reduce or disable these emails, **go to the Jira Dashboard window** and **click on button (4)** in the upper right part of the window. There, **select "Account settings"** and **select the "Email" tab** and then **click on the "email preferences center"** link.

In this new page, you can disable the marketing emails you are not interested in.

Team management

Adding users

Let's now set up your project team. To do this, **go back to the Jira Dashboard window and click on the "Team (1)" menu**. You should reach a new window displaying the only known user: yourself. Let's start by adding your team members. To do so**, click on "Add people"**.



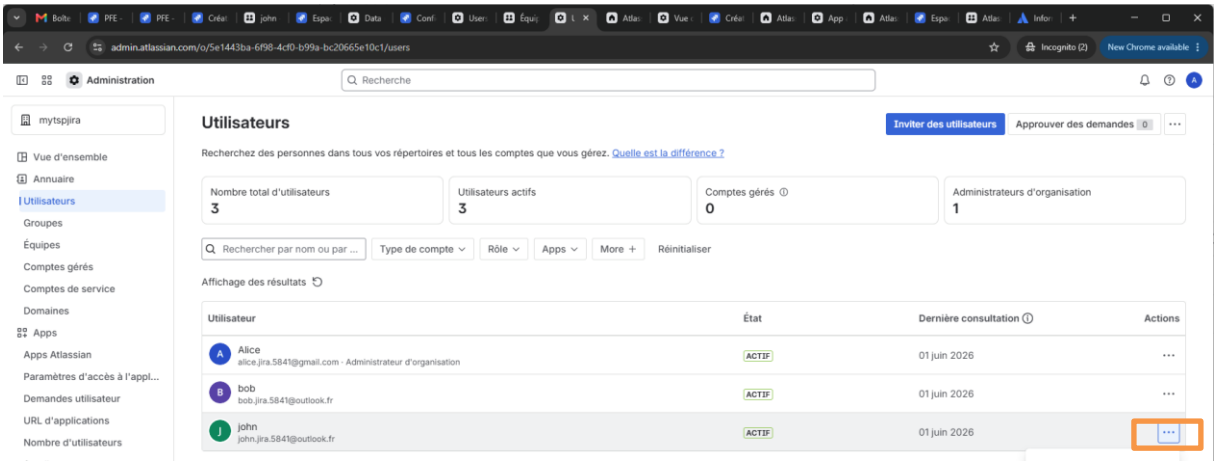
Fill up the form by entering your team member email addresses. Make sure you **clear "Site users to invite other people" and "Verified XXX email users to join"[1] boxes** before adding the users. On the free plan any invited user becomes administrator for the site.

Adding users usually takes a few minutes. After some time, the new users should appear on the list. Don't hesitate to reload the page.

[1] If this box is checked, any user with an email address in the same domain will be able to access your work. This domain-level access can be removed from the Jira Dashboard, by clicking on the « Jira (3) » menu and select « Administration ». There expand the « Apps » folder and select « App Access Settings » and remove from the table any unnecessary domain.

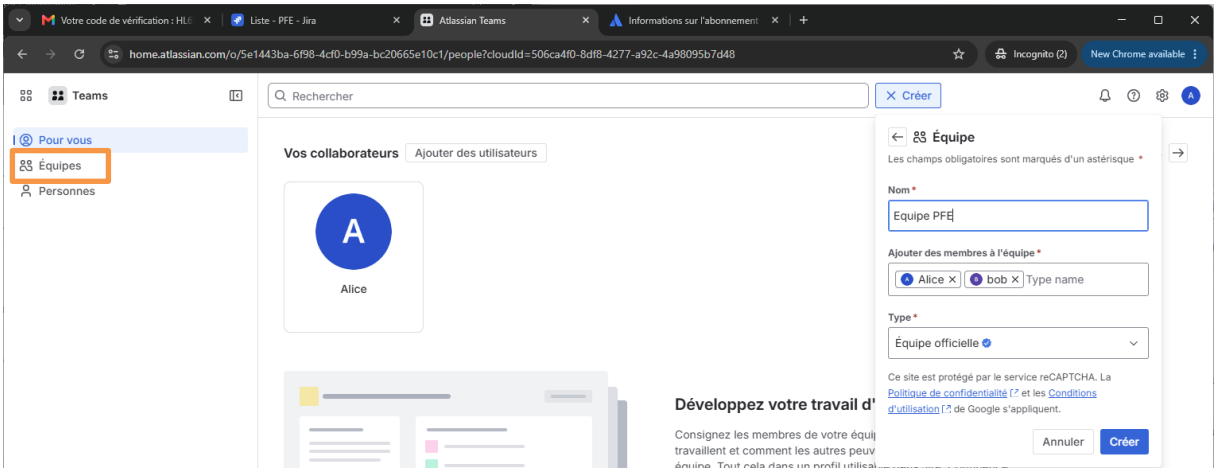
Removing users

In case you might want to remove a user from your users' directory, go back to the Jira Dashboard window and click on the settings (5) button and select "User Management". A new window should open where you get a list of the users in your organization.



To remove a user, click on the "…" button associated with the user and select "Remove User".

Creating a team



On the "Teams" windows, create now the team by **clicking on "Create Team".** In the form, **enter the team's name ("Equipe PFE"), add the team members and click on create**. The new team should appear on the "Teams" page.

Associating a team with your project

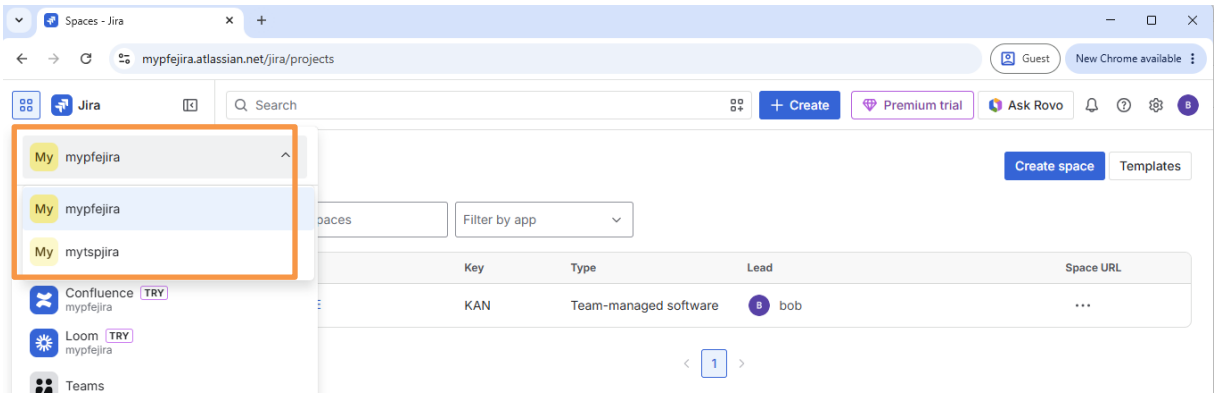
From the Jira Dashboard window, **hover over the project space (2) and click on the "…" button**. There **select "Linked Teams".** In the form, **select the team you just created and click on "Save".** Note that adding a team to a project does not provide any specific rights to the team members.

A project from the invitee's point of view

Let's now have a look at the project from the invitees' point of view. To do this, **open a guest window in your browser and connect to Bob's account in Jira. Finally go to the Jira Dashboard** window.

When added to the inviter's directory, a user will get visibility to the inviter's site and in fact, in the free plan, has almost the same rights as the initial owner. To access the site, **click on the "Jira" (3) zone of**

the Dashboard and you should see a foldable list of sites (here mypfejira, Bob's site and mystpjira, Alice's site) you can access.



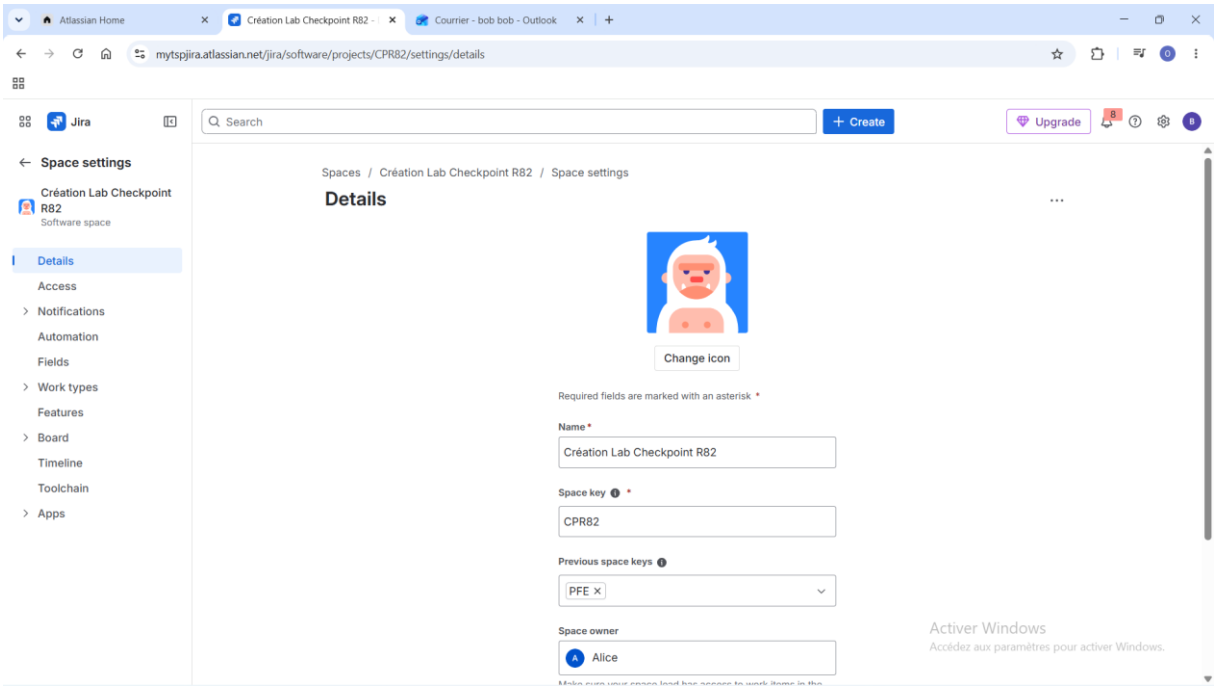
Select Alice's site and then click on Jira below. This should open a new window displaying the projects in Alice's site. **Select the project you want to work on**. You can now modify the project.

Going back to Bob's site follows the same process but instead selecting Bob's site name.

Changing the project configuration

To illustrate Bob's rights on the project space, let's change the project configuration. From the Jira Dashboard window, **hover over the project space (2) and click on the "…" button**. There **select "Space settings"**.

You can there change the name of the project and default key for the project's activities. For instance, when the key "PFE" is selected, each work item will be identified with a code starting with the "PFE" string. **Modify the name to "Création Lab Checkpoint R82" and the project key to "CPR82"**.



Note that other project's settings are accessible from this page. Some of them like the 'Access" tab have a limited use in the free plan.

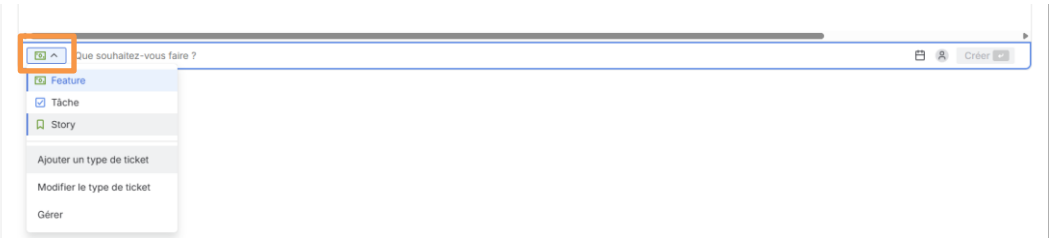
Tasks management

Adding a new type of task

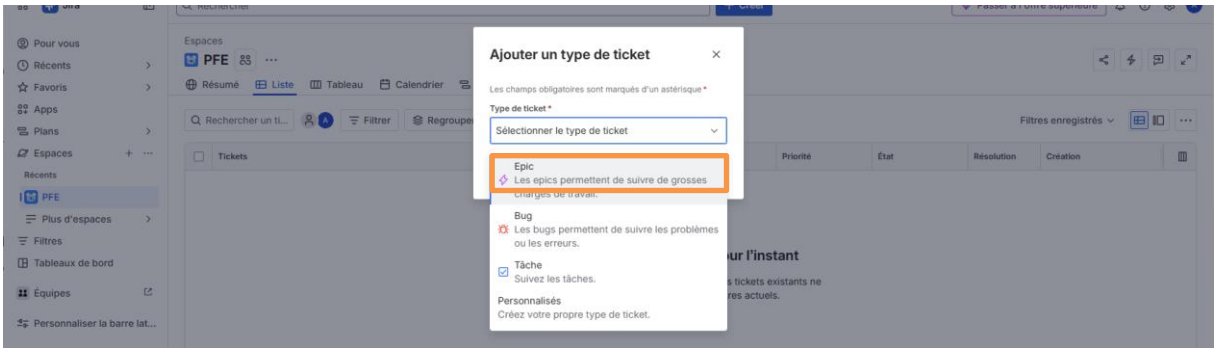
For the moment, the work items that we can create are limited to two levels: Tasks and subtasks. We are now going to add a new type of task (“Epic”) so that the activities can be organized over three levels:

- Epic1
  - Task1
    - Subtask1
    - Subtask2
  - Task2
- Epic2

Go back to Alice’ Jira Dashboard window and **select the “List” tab**. There, **select “Create” (6)** and **click on the icon in the left of the field and select “Add work type”**.



In the new form, **select “Epic”**. As explained, “Epic” work items can be used to represent large workloads that can be later decomposed in tasks.



Creating a first workload

Let’s suppose that the work is organized around three main activities, “Etude de R82”, “Migration TP Existant” and “Adaptation aux nouvelles fonctionnalités”.

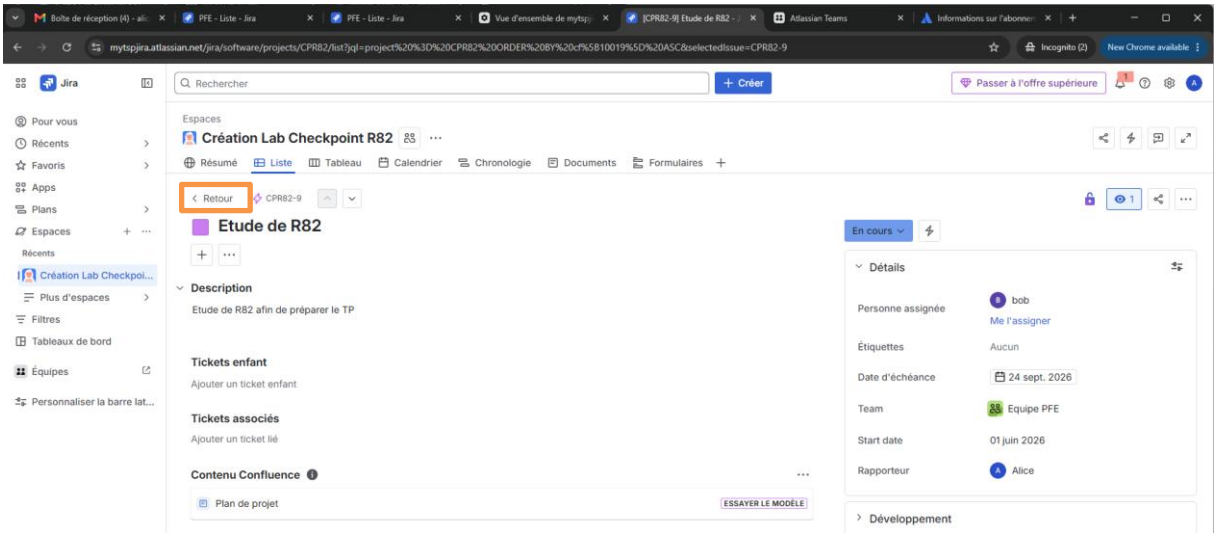


To create a first task, select “Epic” and type the name of the workload (“Etude de R82”) **and click on “Create”**. The “Epic” appears in the list.

Setting up the workload



To configure the “Epic”, **click on the task key**. A new form opens where you can enter the different characteristics of the work item such as its description, the person in charge, the reporter: the client for the task. The reporter during the project should be the supervisor for your project. Describing a starting date and a due date. **Fill up the form according to the values seen below**. **Once finished click on “Back”** to go back to the list.



Note that the cells in the list also allow you to change the values for some of the fields associated with a task.

Create the following workloads:

Summary	Issue Type	Status	Priority	Assignee	Reporter	Start date	Due date
Etude de R82	Epic	In progress	Medium	bob	john	03/06/2026	10/10/2026
Migration TP Existant	Epic	To do	Medium	Alice	john	03/07/2026	03/08/2026

Setting up a workload related task and subtask



Let’s now subdivide this workload in multiple tasks. To associate a task to a workload, in the list, **select the ‘+’ related to the workload** you want to decompose. A new line should appear where you can configure the task.

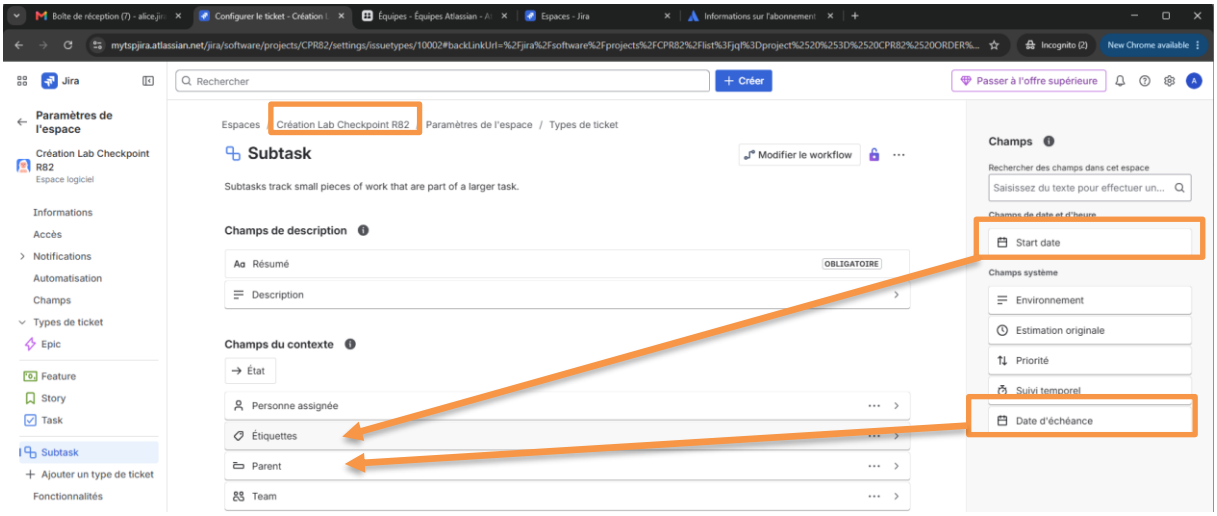
Create the tasks as displayed below for the “Etude de R82” “Epic”.

Summary	Issue Type	Status	Priority	Assignee	Reporter	Start date	Due date
Etude de la documentation R82	Task	In progress	Highest	bob	john	03/06/2026	02/10/2026
Mise en place d'un banc de test	Task	In Progress	High	bob	john	04/06/2026	07/06/2026

The process can be repeated for subtasks. By selecting a task and clicking on the associated ‘+’. **Create a subtask for task “Mise en place d’un banc de test” called “Identification de l'environnement physique”**.

Tuning a work item's fields

By default, subtasks are not associated with a “Start date” or a “Due date” field. Let’s see how this can be solved. To do this **click on the Key (CPR82-X) associated with the subtask you created**. At the bottom of the window, **click on “Configure”**.

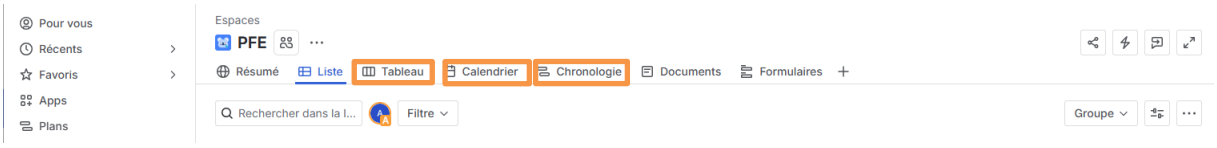


To modify the subtask object type, **select the “Start date” item on the right part of the screen and drag it to the place where it should appear on the left side. Do the same operation for the “Due date” field**.

Once finished **click on the project name to go back to the list**. **Create or update the following subtasks for task “Mise en place d’un banc de test”**:

Summary	Issue Type	Status	Priority	Assignee	Reporter	Start date	Due date
Identification de l'environnement physique	Subtask	Done	Medium	bob	john	04/06/2026	05/06/2026
Identification de l'environnement virtuel	Subtask	Done	Medium	bob	john	04/06/2026	05/06/2026
Installation de CP R82	Subtask	Done	Medium	bob	john	05/06/2026	07/06/2026

Other views for work items

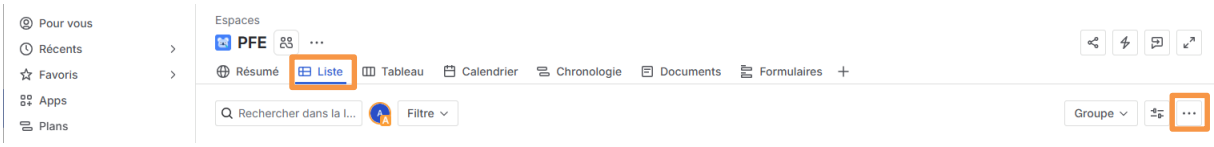


So far, we have used the list view for work items. The dashboard provides additional views:

- The Board view is used to represent the level of progress for each activity in the project.
- The Calendar view provides a calendar where tasks are represented over a weekly or monthly period.
- The Timeline view is similar to the calendar view but represents time over a single axis similarly to a Gantt diagram. The time granularity can be week, month or trimester based.

Exporting tasks information

Tasks can be exported from Jira in various formats. To do so select the task list tab and click on the "…" on the right side of the window.



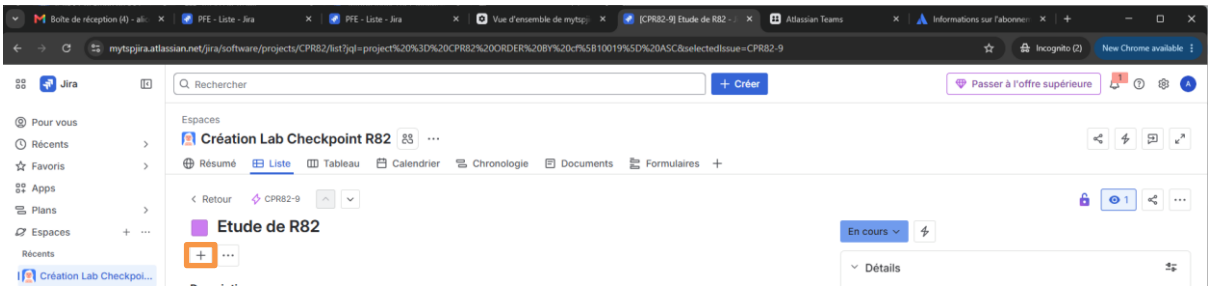
There, click on "Export" and select the format you want to be used for the export. Once selected, the file is automatically downloaded by your browser and usually located in your "Download" folder.

Note that the same menu can be used to import tasks. To do so, tasks must be described in a CSV file with column headers that you can match to those produced by Jira.

Documents

Using attachments.

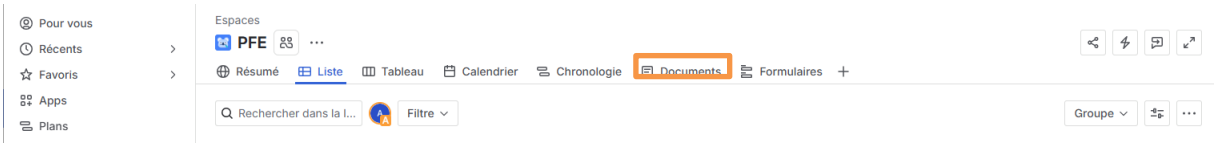
Jira allows you to attach information and files to work item objects. To do so, **go the Jira Dashboard** page and **open the "Etude de R82" work item**. **Click on the '+'** under the task name and **select "Add Attachment"**.



Add a file to the workload.

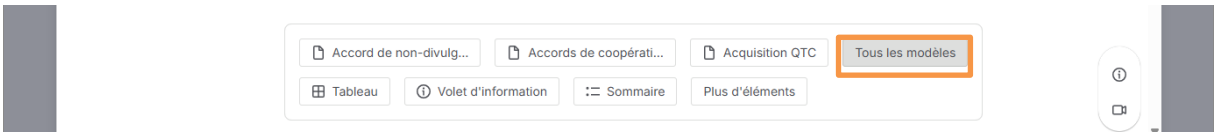
Using the Docs tab.

Attachments are interesting, however, another storage space is needed for documents you want to collaborate on.



The "Docs" tab on the Jira Dashboard window provides the ability to link a Jira space to a document space managed by another Atlassian tool called "Confluence". To access this space, **click on the "Docs" tab** and then on the **"Try Confluence"** button. Pass the Confluence presentation and wait for the space to be set up. Once the page is updated, **click on the "Create your first page" button**.

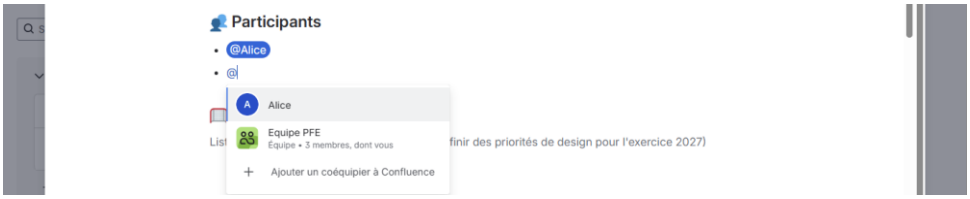
Atlassian provides a set of templates that can be used to speed up the writing of documents. Let's assume we want to set up meeting notes. To search for the template, **click on "All templates"**.



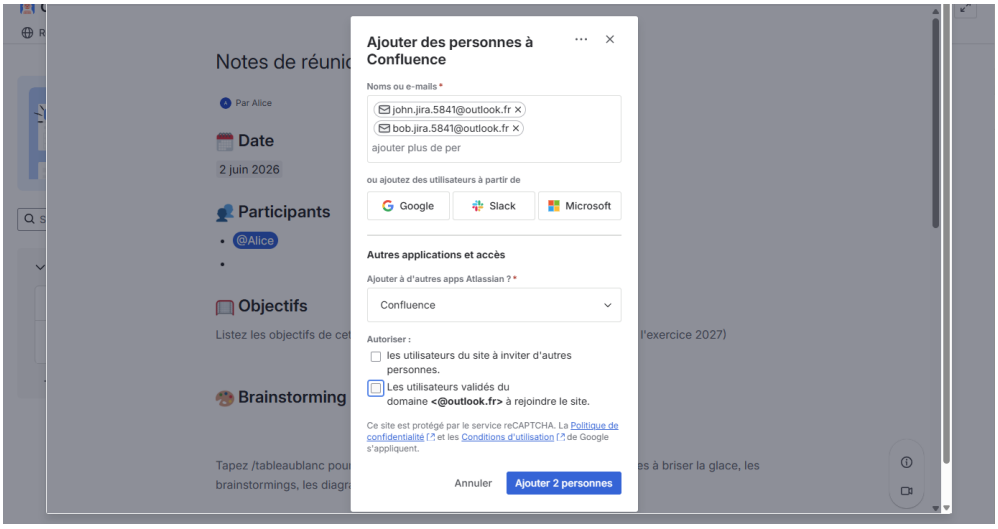
In the right side of the windows, **scroll through the templates until you find "Meeting Notes". Select it**, the document on the left side should be filled partially using the chosen template.

Using links in documents.

Most objects in Atlassian can be linked to each other. Let's for example connect the team members to these meeting notes. For this in the "Participants" section, **add a bullet point and start the line with the '@' character**.

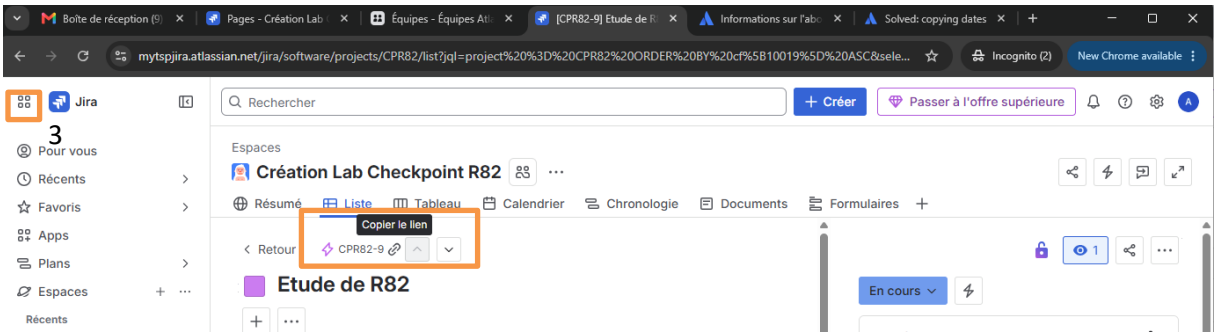


Because Confluence and Jira are two different products, users have to be added again to allow them access to this new application. **Select "Add teammate to Confluence"**.



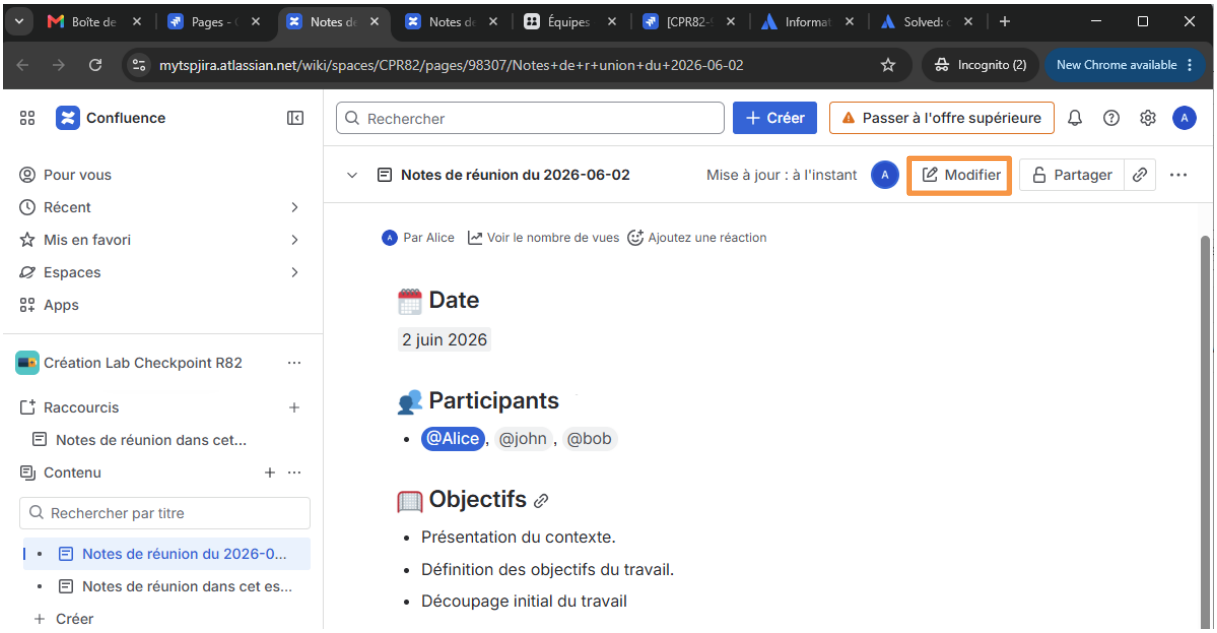
A registration form should appear. **Enter the email addresses of the members of your team and <u>make sure you clear "Site users to invite other people" and "Verified XXX email users to join" boxes</u>** before adding the users. **Add the members of your team**.

Adding the members might take a few minutes to be effective. In the meantime, save the document using the **"Publish" button and close the page** and on the Jira Dashboard page, **click on the "List" tab**. **Open the "Etude de R82" workload and hover your mouse over the key** (CPR82-X). This gives you the ability to copy a link to the activity.



Copy the link and click on the top left (3) button. A new line should have appeared on the menu, giving you the ability to access the Confluence application. **Click on "Confluence"**.

In order to get access to the document you created, **click on "Spaces" and select the space associated with your project**. The document you created should appear under the "Content" section.

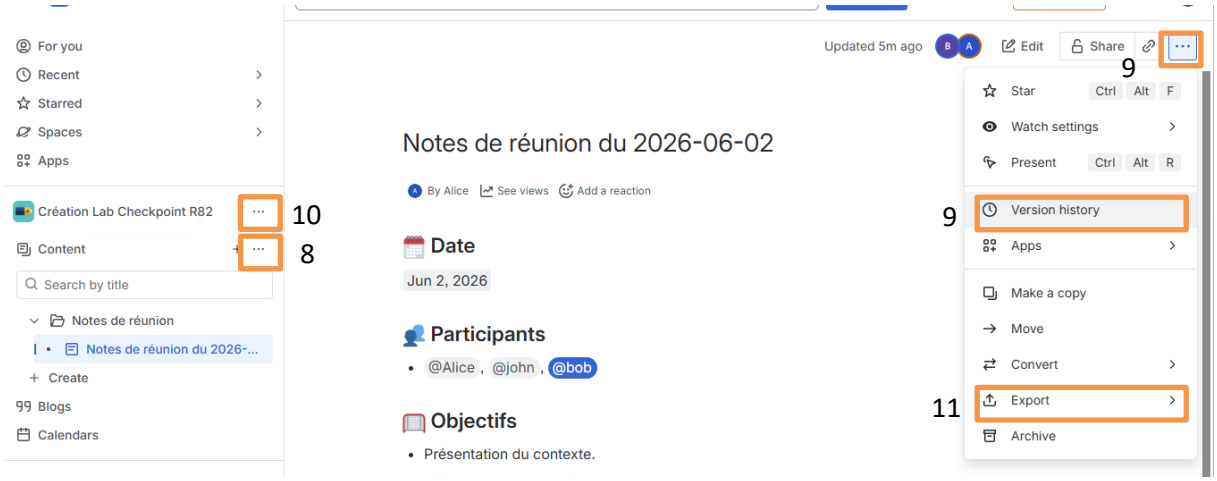


Click on the document to display it and on the "Edit" button to modify it.

- In the "Participants" section, **add team members by starting a line with the '@' character** and selecting the members in the list.
- In the "Action items" section, **paste the link to the workload** to link the two objects.

Manipulating documents

Confluence provides many files management functions that are not present in the Jira "Docs" tab. You can create, copy, move, delete files and folders. To access these functions, hover your mouse over a file or the "Content" section and on click the associated '…' button (8).



Any object created in the project space in Confluence should appear in the “Docs” tab associated with the project in Jira.

Versioning and exporting documents

Another useful function in Confluence is versioning. To access versioning, select a file and click on the “…” (9) button in the top right part of the window. Click on “Version history”. Versioning allows you to see when and by whom the document was changed. It also allows you to restore former versions.

The same menu can be used to export documents from Confluence in various formats. To do so select again the “…” (9) button on the right side of the window and click on “Export “. You can then select the format you want to export the document to. Once selected your browser will download the file in the requested format and usually place it in the “Download” folder.

Cleanup

This ends this tutorial regarding Jira and Confluence. To clean up the created project, click on the ‘…’ button (10) associated with the project and select “Delete Space”. Confirm then twice that you want to send the space to trash.

Finally, make sure that your Jira account is used regularly. For the free plan, accounts and sites that remain inactive for more than 120 days get disabled.

References

https://support.atlassian.com/jira-software-cloud/
https://support.atlassian.com/confluence-cloud/
https://community.atlassian.com/